"Hi Fatima, isn't this fun?" I called out as my friend came into the compartment. "Come, sit here. I have kept a seat for you. You can keep your bag next to mine. What have you brought to eat?" "Parotta and delicious chutney. Did you see the train? It's so beautiful!" Fatima replied.

Our teacher, Geetha madam, came around to see if everyone was seated properly. "The train is about to leave so take your seats everyone," she said. Just then the train started with a jerk. It moved very slowly, leaving the station with a long hoot. Everyone clapped. The train went **snaking** up the steep hillside, weaving its way through forests of tall trees **swaying** in the breeze.

One of the boys, Muthu, said, "It is going so slowly, I can walk along its side." And he got up to go to the door.

From the other end the teacher saw him and said in a firm voice, "Muthu, go back to your seat at once." The girls **sniggered** and Muthu sat down with a long face.

Read the following questions and answer them.

1. Where did the boys and girls go?
2. Why did Muthu say that he could walk along its side?
3. Why did the girls snigger?

GLOSSARY

Mesh	-	Material made of a network of wire or thread
Swaying	-	Moving slowly or rhythmically
Snaking	-	Moving like a snake
Sniggered	-	Laughed in a half suppressed way

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